Lesson 1.2: Dealing With Our Sin

Genesis 3 · Series 1: In the Beginning · About 20 minutes · Big idea: **Sorry is not enough. Repentance is turning around.**

> **Key verse: Luke 9:23**
>
> 23 And he said to them all, If any man will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross daily, and follow me.

Bring: candy · a cake or a paper plate "cake" with a few candles · the 4 candle part sheets printed

1. Testimony 2 min

1 student (or a teacher on the rotation). If they need a prompt: *a time you said sorry, and then actually changed.*

2. Act it out: The Birthday Candles 4 min

The Birthday Candles

Birthday Kid · **Best Friend** · **Parent** · **Guests** (everyone else sings)

The party

Birthday Kid stands at the table. Guests gather around. Parent "lights" the candles.

PARENT **Okay everybody, here comes the cake! Ready? One, two, three...**

GUESTS **Happy birthday to you...**

Best Friend cuts in front and blows out the candles.

BIRTHDAY KID **Hey! What did you do that for?**

BEST FRIEND **Oh, I am so sorry. I shouldn't have done that.**

BIRTHDAY KID **It's okay. I forgive you.**

PARENT **Let's try again. One, two, three...**

GUESTS **Happy birthday to you, happy birthday to you...**

Best Friend cuts in again and blows out the candles.

BIRTHDAY KID **Why did you do that?**

BEST FRIEND **I don't know. I just couldn't help myself. I'm sorry.**

BIRTHDAY KID **Fine. I forgive you. But don't do it again.**

PARENT **Last time. One, two, three...**

GUESTS **Happy birthday to you, happy birthday dear friend, happy birthday...**

Best Friend bursts in and blows out ALL the candles.

BIRTHDAY KID **STOP IT!**

BEST FRIEND **I'm so sorry...**

PARENT **Forget it. I'm just cutting the cake. Worst birthday ever.**

🍬 **1. How many times did he say he was sorry? Then why did he keep doing it?**

Three times. He never CHANGED. Sorry is a feeling. Repentance is turning around.

3. What happened in the garden 6 min

God made everything good, and He made man to walk with Him. He gave Adam one rule.

> **Genesis 2:17**
>
> 17 But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it: for in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die.

The serpent got her to doubt God first: *"Yea, hath God said...?"* Then he called God a liar: *"Ye shall not surely die."*

Genesis 3:4-6

4 And the serpent said unto the woman, Ye shall not surely die:
5 For God doth know that in the day ye eat thereof, then your eyes shall be opened, and ye shall be as gods, knowing good and evil.
6 And when the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was pleasant to the eyes, and a tree to be desired to make one wise, she took of the fruit thereof, and did eat, and gave also unto her husband with her; and he did eat.

Now watch what they do when God comes walking.

Genesis 3:8-13

8 And they heard the voice of the LORD God walking in the garden in the cool of the day: and Adam and his wife hid themselves from the presence of the LORD God amongst the trees of the garden.
9 And the LORD God called unto Adam, and said unto him, Where art thou?
10 And he said, I heard thy voice in the garden, and I was afraid, because I was naked; and I hid myself.
11 And he said, Who told thee that thou wast naked? Hast thou eaten of the tree, whereof I commanded thee that thou shouldest not eat?
12 And the man said, The woman whom thou gavest to be with me, she gave me of the tree, and I did eat.
13 And the LORD God said unto the woman, What is this that thou hast done? And the woman said, The serpent beguiled me, and I did eat.

🍬 **2. Count them. How many times did Adam or Eve say "I'm sorry"? And who did Adam blame?**

ZERO. Adam blamed the woman, AND God: "the woman whom THOU gavest." Eve blamed the serpent. Follow up, no candy: *who do YOU blame?*

4. God made a way 3 min

Sin had to be judged, but God did not leave them there. He promised a Saviour from the woman's seed:

> **Genesis 3:15**
>
> 15 And I will put enmity between thee and the woman, and between thy seed and her seed; it shall bruise thy head, and thou shalt bruise his heel.

And He covered them. Fig leaves were their idea. God's covering cost a life:

> **Genesis 3:21**
>
> 21 Unto Adam also and to his wife did the LORD God make coats of skins, and clothed them.

Repentance is not a one time thing. Paul said:

> **1 Corinthians 15:31**
>
> 31 I protest by your rejoicing which I have in Christ Jesus our Lord, I die daily.

Every day we put our flesh (our selfish nature) back on the altar. That is the *daily* in Luke 9:23.

5. Your story, or an illustration 2 min

Pick one: a crew guy who kept saying sorry for the same mistake, a time YOU had to stop apologizing and fix it, or a time hiding made it worse. **Or** *The Pilgrim's Progress* (John Bunyan): Christian flees the City of Destruction and his burden rolls off at the cross.

6. What would you do? 3 min

🍬 **3. You lost your temper with your little brother Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday, and said sorry every time. It is Thursday morning. What do you do?**

EVERYONE who answers gets candy. Look for turning around: pray first, walk away, go to God before it happens again.

> **Acts 3:19**
>
> 19 Repent ye therefore, and be converted, that your sins may be blotted out, when the times of refreshing shall come from the presence of the Lord;

The big church: the altar is where the church goes to repent. When you see people at the altar, now you know what is happening, and that it is for you too.

Prayer 1 min

Jesus, we admit that we are sinners today. We recognize that we have missed the mark of your righteousness time and time again. We're asking for You to forgive us. More importantly, we commit to repenting of our sin. From this day forward we will work to turn away from things that do not please You. Please give us the strength to live victoriously.